THE CHRISTMAS COUNTDOWN

ACTIVITY PACKET

2 EDITIONS: 15 SCHOOL DAYS + 24 DAYS IN DECEMBER



PRINTABLE • GRADES 1-4 • 15 SCHOOL DAYS EDITION

TEACHER NOTES

WHAT'S INCLUDED

- School Days Edition: 15 school days, counting down to winter break, with classroom kindness challenges.
- Home Edition: the full 24 days (December 1 to 24). Great as a take-home gift for families.
- Each edition: countdown calendar, wish list, daily puzzle + Daily Fun pages, certificate and answer keys.

WHEN TO START

- For a break that begins after Friday, December 18, start the School Days Edition on Monday, November 30. Fifteen school days later is the last day before break. Adjust to your school calendar.

WAYS TO USE IT

- Morning work or a calm start after lunch.
- Early-finisher folder: print the whole packet and let students work ahead.
- Kindness wall: post each day's challenge and let students add a sticker when they complete it.
- Take-home: send the Home Edition home before break for families to enjoy.

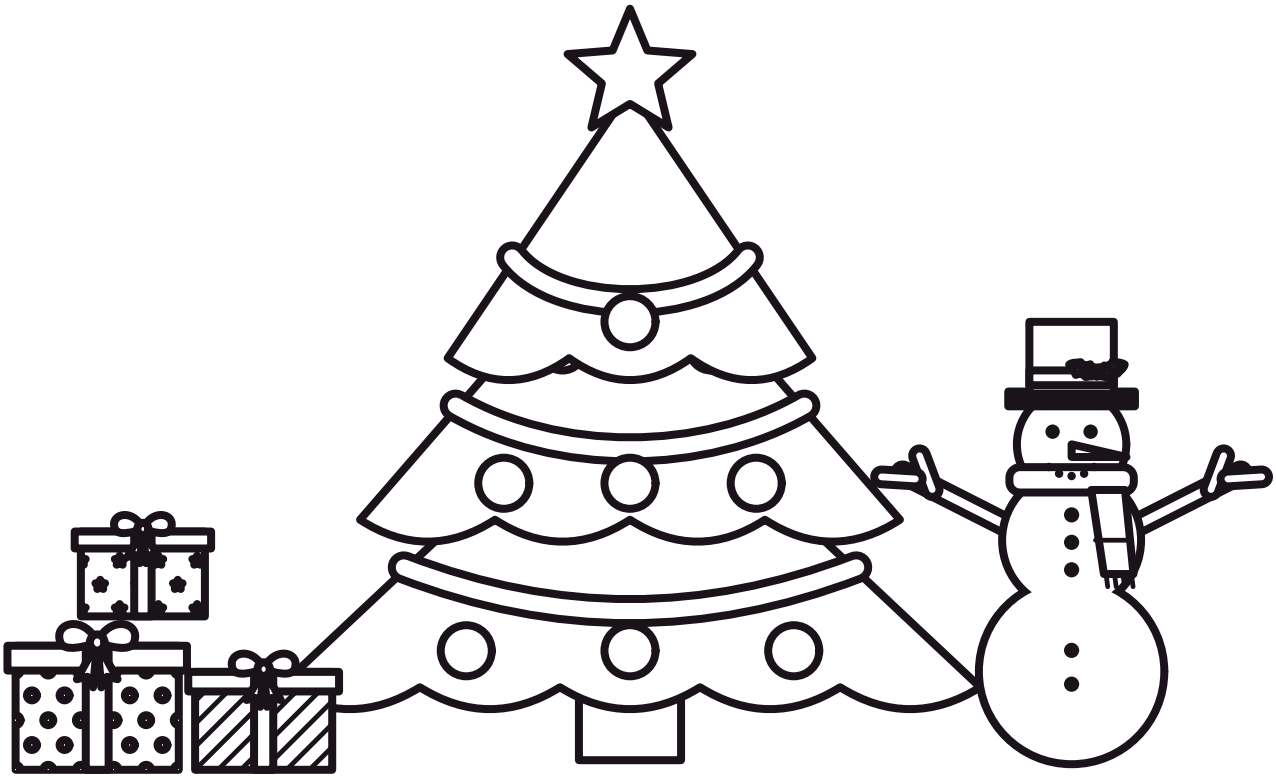
PRINTING TIPS

- Print single-sided in black and white. Each day is two pages: the puzzle and the Daily Fun page.
- Keep the answer keys at the back of the file for yourself, or print them for self-checking.

THE CHRISTMAS COUNTDOWN

SCHOOL DAYS EDITION

15 School Days of Puzzles, Coloring and Kindness



THANK YOU!

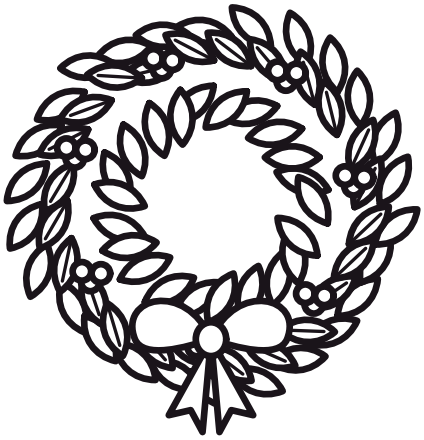
Terms of Use

Thank you for downloading this resource! I hope it brings lots of kindness and holiday fun to your students.

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READ ME FIRST

How It Works

One day at a time

Each school day has two pages: a puzzle and a Daily Fun page. Do one day each school day. No skipping ahead!

Daily Fun

Read the joke of the day (the answer is upside down), color the picture, and try the kindness challenge.

Color your calendar

When you finish a day, color its door on the Countdown Calendar on the next page.

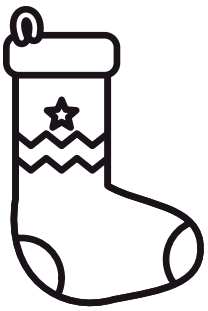
Puzzles

Word searches, mazes, secret messages, sudoku and word scrambles. The codes use 1 = A, 2 = B and so on.

Finish line

On the last day before winter break, fill in your certificate at the back. You did it!

Stuck on a puzzle? The answers start on page 37.



COLOR A DOOR EACH DAY

My Countdown Calendar

When you finish a school day, color in its door. When all 15 are colored, it's winter break!

3	4	14
13	☆ 15	2
7	8	1
9	11	6
12	5	10

My Christmas Wish List

Write or draw what you are wishing for this year.

- ☆ _____
- ☆ _____
- ☆ _____
- ☆ _____
- ☆ _____
- ☆ _____
- ☆ _____
- ☆ _____
- ☆ _____
- ☆ _____
- ☆ _____
- ☆ _____



Love from: _____

SCHOOL DAY 1

Counting Down

Find every word hidden in the grid. Words go across, down and diagonally.

K	S	S	C	D	O	J	H	A	D	R	N	U	I
F	G	D	O	D	E	C	E	M	B	E	R	P	G
B	W	O	U	T	R	E	A	T	U	I	B	L	R
E	R	O	N	W	J	N	P	N	E	B	E	A	J
N	E	R	T	A	S	C	S	B	D	T	U	J	B
Y	A	S	D	I	F	A	J	T	T	L	Y	T	H
S	T	T	O	T	F	L	T	P	A	S	E	G	P
U	H	E	W	I	S	E	U	N	I	R	A	H	J
R	K	X	N	N	P	N	W	D	B	J	D	C	O
P	G	C	D	G	U	D	K	J	Y	R	N	H	E
R	U	I	B	D	D	A	B	G	C	E	W	Y	S
I	K	T	H	S	P	R	R	L	C	V	C	Y	A
S	K	E	I	A	J	S	T	M	R	K	A	R	O
E	P	D	D	T	W	W	V	W	O	D	Y	D	G

- ☐ CALENDAR
- ☐ CANDLE
- ☐ COUNTDOWN
- ☐ DAYS
- ☐ DECEMBER
- ☐ DOORS
- ☐ EXCITED
- ☐ STAR
- ☐ SURPRISE
- ☐ TREAT
- ☐ WAITING
- ☐ WREATH

SCHOOL DAY 1

15 School Days to Go!

JOKE OF THE DAY

What do you call Santa when he takes a break?

Answer: Santa Pause!



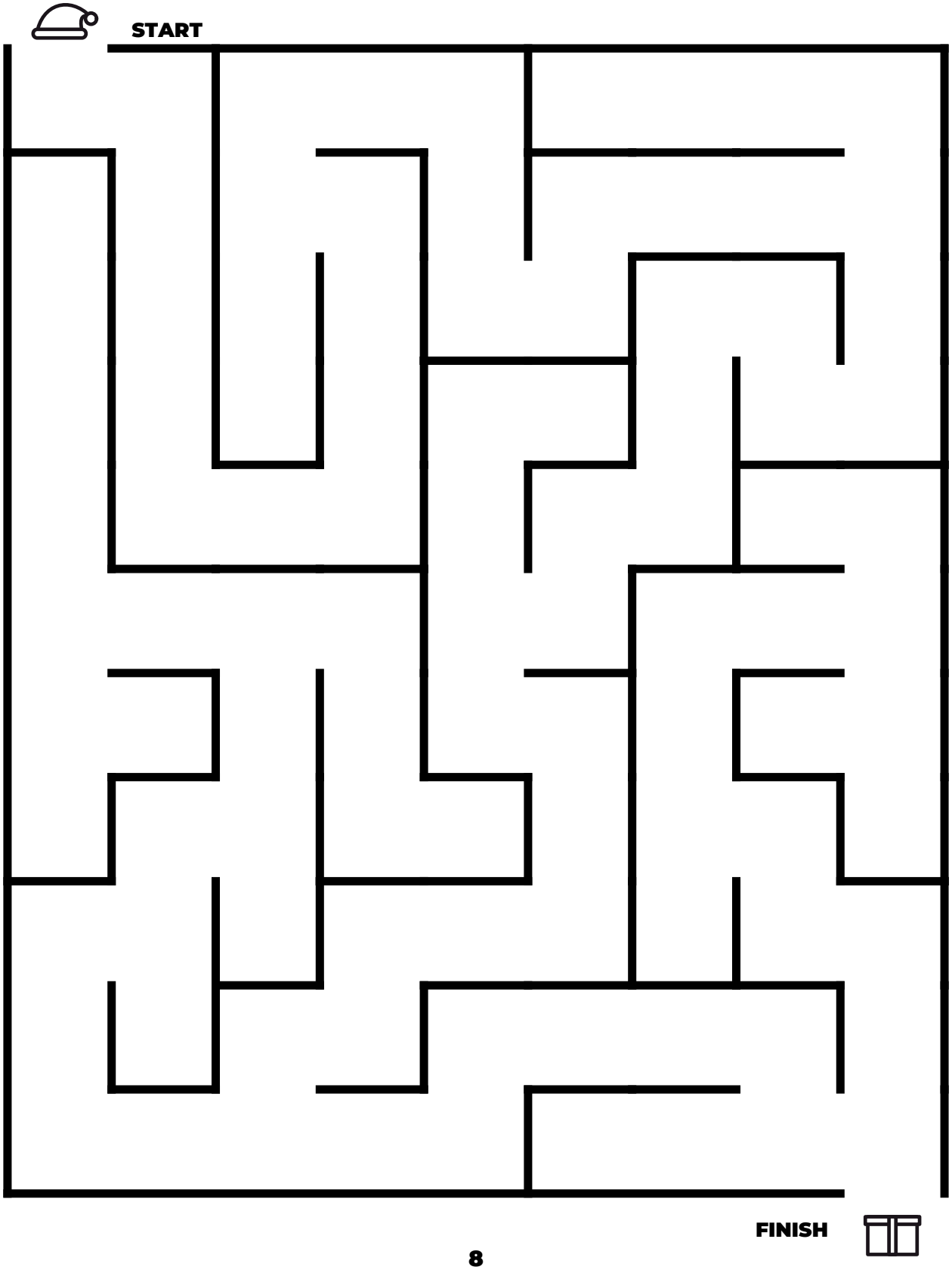
TODAY'S KINDNESS CHALLENGE

Give a classmate a compliment.

☐ **I DID IT!**

Help the elf find the sleigh

Start at the top. Find the path to the bottom.



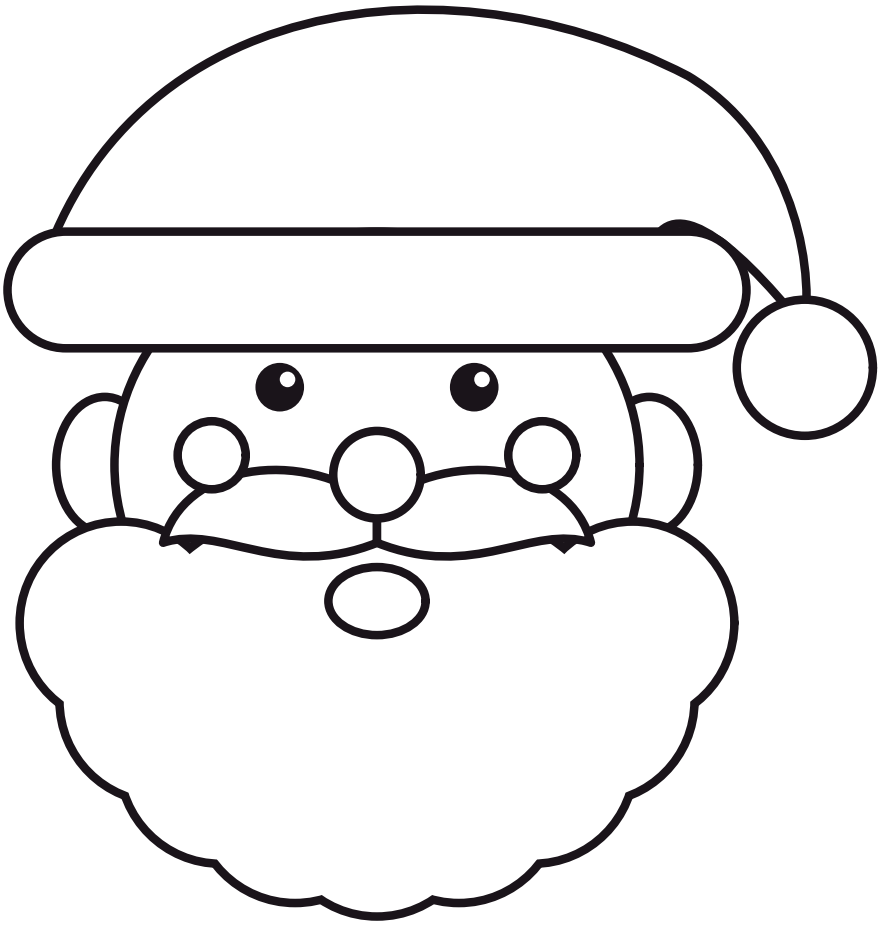
SCHOOL DAY 2

14 School Days to Go!

JOKE OF THE DAY

What do snowmen like to do on the weekend?

Answer: Chill out!



TODAY'S KINDNESS CHALLENGE

Hold the door open for someone.

☐ **I DID IT!**

Secret Messages

The elves sent you a secret message. Use the code key to decode it!

A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13

N	O	P	Q	R	S	T	U	V	W	X	Y	Z
14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26

Secret message 1:

19	1	14	20	1		9	19		3	15	13	9	14	7									

19	15	15	14																				

Secret message 2:

25	15	21		1	18	5		15	14		20	8	5										

14	9	3	5		12	9	19	20															

Secret message 3:

8	1	22	5		1		3	15	15	11	9	5											

20	15	4	1	25																			

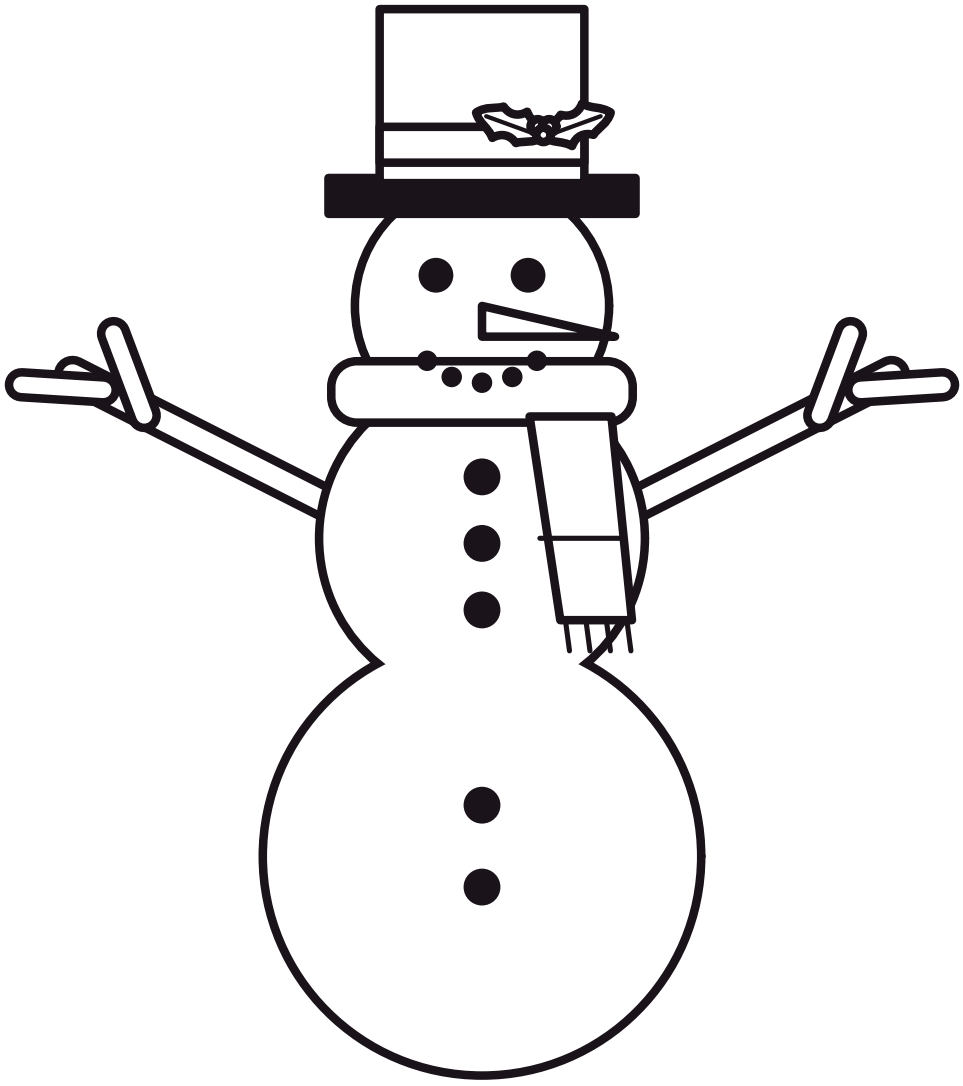
SCHOOL DAY 3

13 School Days to Go!

JOKE OF THE DAY

What kind of ball doesn't bounce?

Answer: A snowball!



TODAY'S KINDNESS CHALLENGE

Help clean up the classroom.

☐ **I DID IT!**

SCHOOL DAY 4

Baking Scramble

Unscramble the letters to spell a Christmas word.

1. **U L F O R** _____
2. **G A U S R** _____
3. **T B U R T E** _____
4. **D G H U O** _____
5. **E O V N** _____
6. **A N R O P** _____
7. **N I C I G** _____
8. **T I R E M** _____
9. **A R K E B** _____
10. **X I M R E** _____

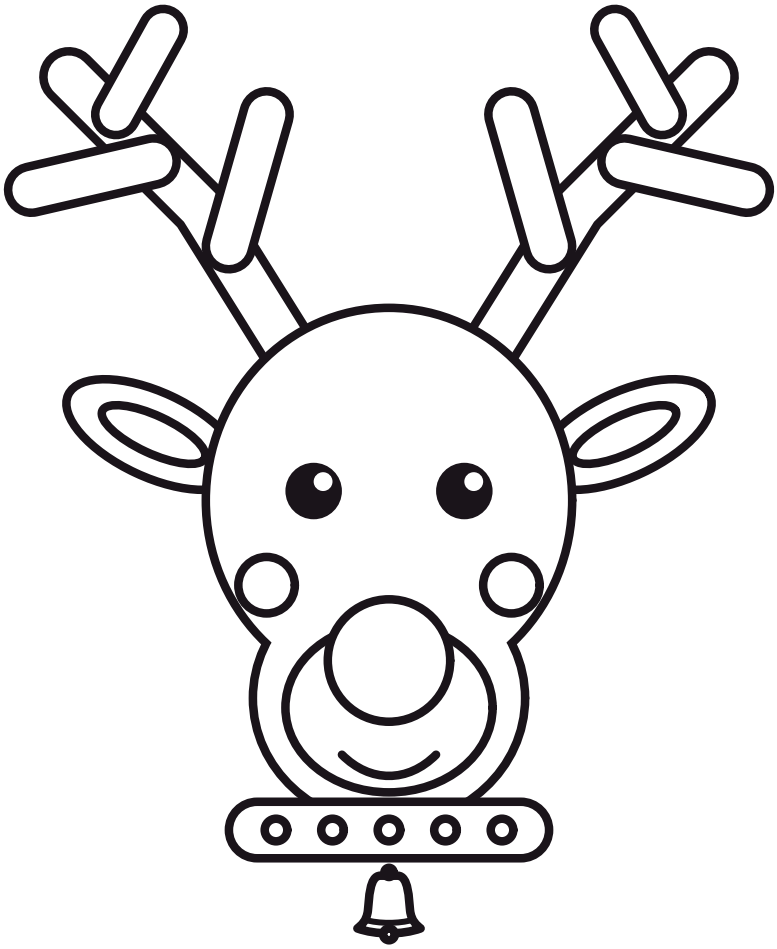
SCHOOL DAY 4

12 School Days to Go!

JOKE OF THE DAY

What do reindeer hang on their trees?

Answer: Horn-aments!



TODAY'S KINDNESS CHALLENGE

Write a thank-you note to your teacher.

☐ **I DID IT!**

Holiday Baking

Find every word hidden in the grid. Words go across, down and diagonally.

T J L P I C W C O O K I E S
K O O F A P R O N V D M V L
A I K L U I C I N G W L S O
V C K O F O V E N V I P D L
T U G U F U G P R P O S K M
I T S R C W W D O U G H P G
M T H U V C H W B U T T E R
E E Y L G R H B C S L N A Y
R R W S D A O P O H A F G C
B S G W R W R L B L W C P F
V G S P R I N K L E S A L F
N K M U C U S O K I N M R A
S A K C H S D L E D N G O P
G J E P B K M I K N J G C T

- ☐ APRON
- ☐ BUTTER
- ☐ COOKIES
- ☐ CUTTERS
- ☐ DOUGH
- ☐ FLOUR
- ☐ ICING
- ☐ OVEN
- ☐ ROLLING
- ☐ SPRINKLES
- ☐ SUGAR
- ☐ TIMER

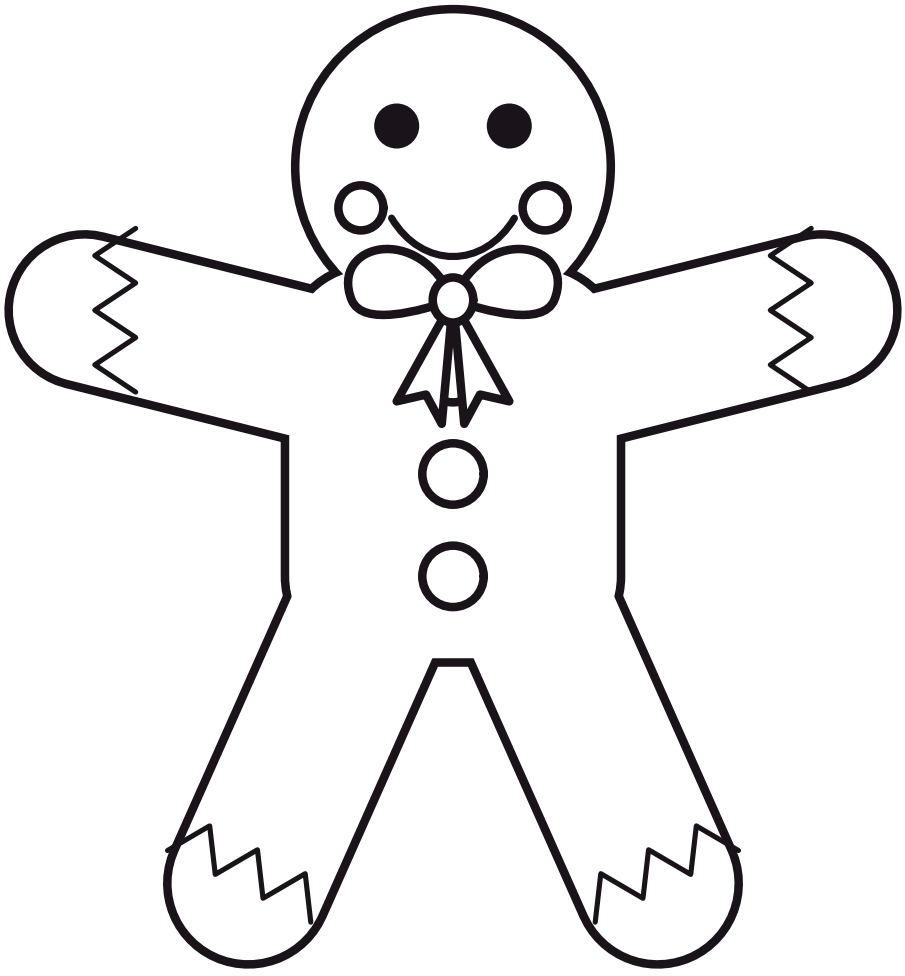
SCHOOL DAY 5

11 School Days to Go!

JOKE OF THE DAY

How do you know Santa is good at karate?

Answer: He has a black belt!



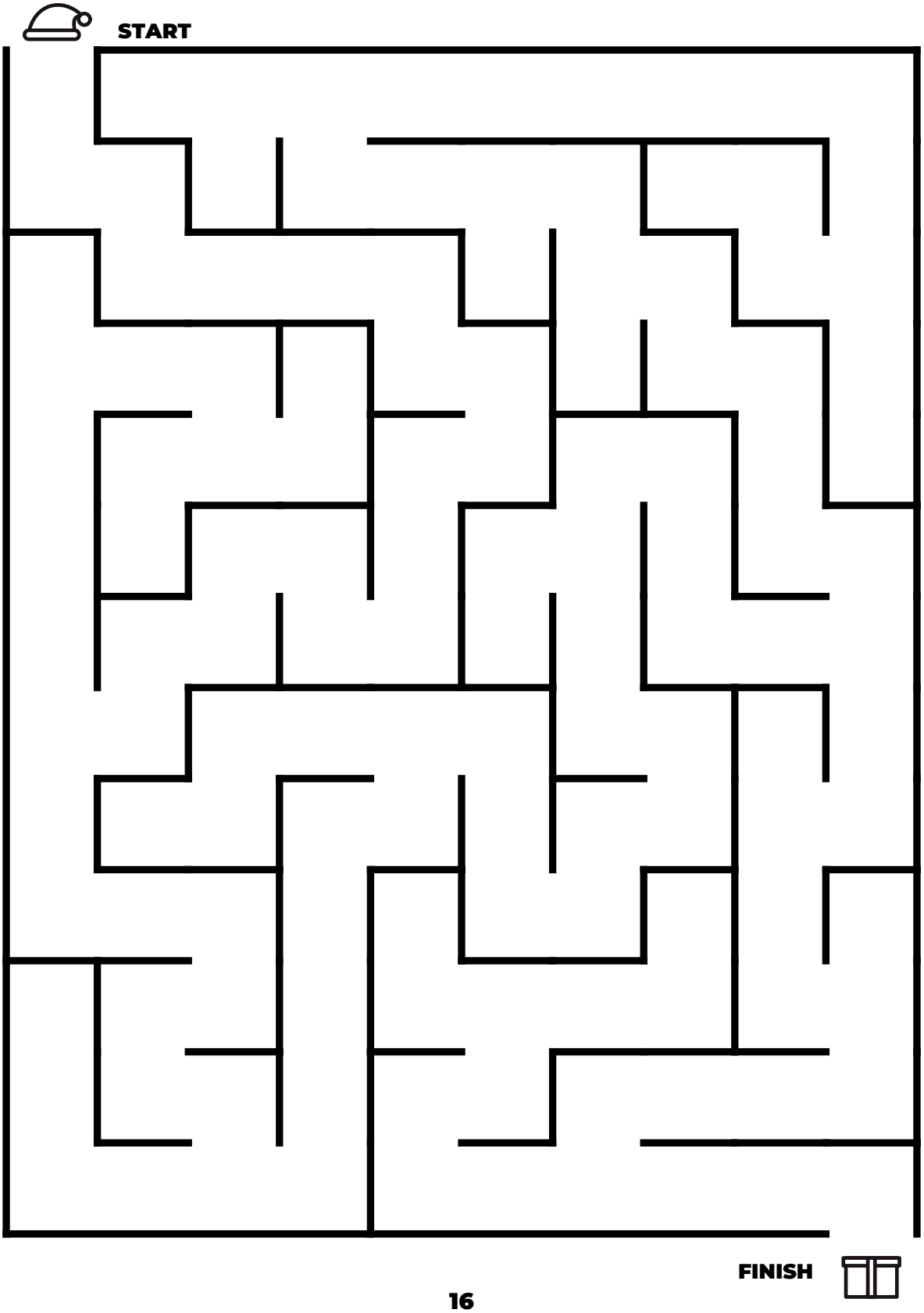
TODAY'S KINDNESS CHALLENGE

Make a card for the office staff or nurse.

☐ **I DID IT!**

Get the letter to Santa

Start at the top. Find the path to the bottom.



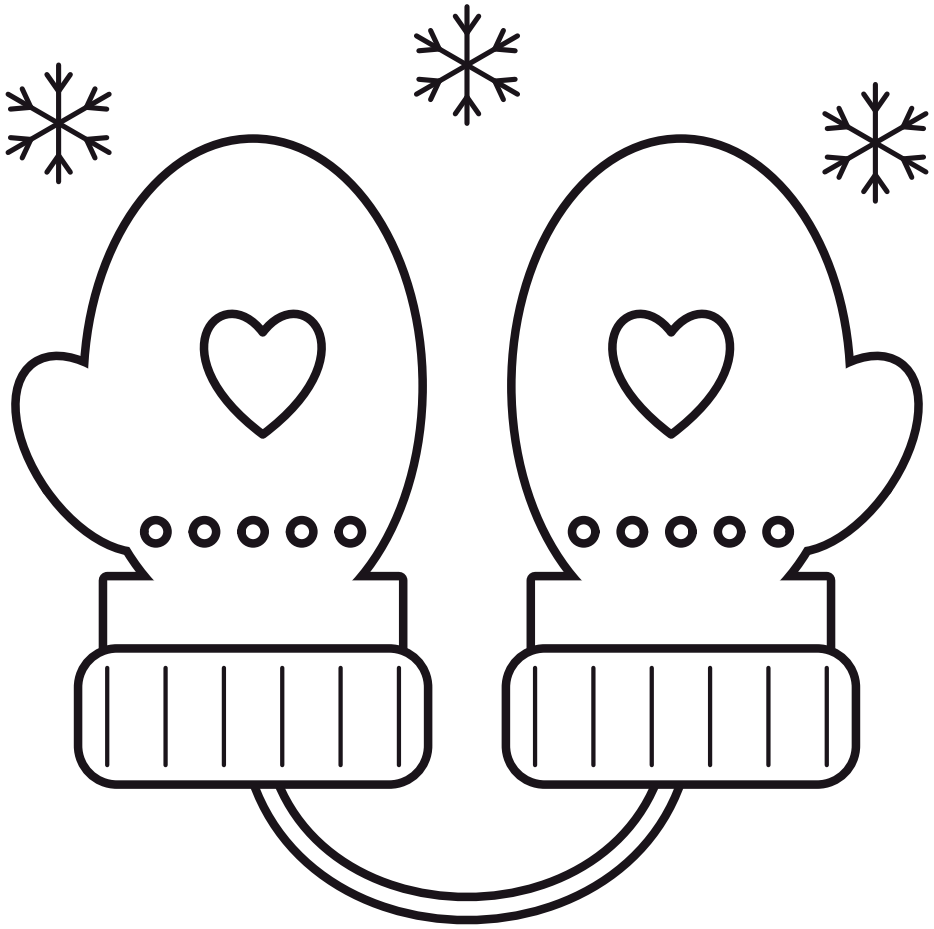
SCHOOL DAY 6

10 School Days to Go!

JOKE OF THE DAY

What did the gingerbread man put on his bed?

Answer: A cookie sheet!



TODAY'S KINDNESS CHALLENGE

Invite someone new to play at recess.

☐ **I DID IT!**

Secret Messages

The elves sent you a secret message. Use the code key to decode it!

A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13

N	O	P	Q	R	S	T	U	V	W	X	Y	Z
14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26

Secret message 4:

20	8	5		18	5	9	14	4	5	5	18		1	18	5									

18	5	1	4	25

Secret message 5:

12	15	15	11		15	21	20		6	15	18		19	14	15	23								

Secret message 6:

11	9	14	4	14	5	19	19		9	19		13	1	7	9	3								

SCHOOL DAY 7

9 School Days to Go!

JOKE OF THE DAY

Why is it so cold at Christmas?

Answer: Because it's Decembrrrr!



TODAY'S KINDNESS CHALLENGE

Share your supplies with a friend.

☐ **I DID IT!**

Snowflake Sudoku

Fill each row, each column and each thick-lined box with the numbers 1 to 6.
No repeats!

PUZZLE A

5		2			6
			4		2
4	1	6			3
3		5	6		4
	6		2	4	
	5		3		

PUZZLE B

	2	6	5	4	
	5	3		1	2
					5
3			4		
	6		3		4
5	3			6	1

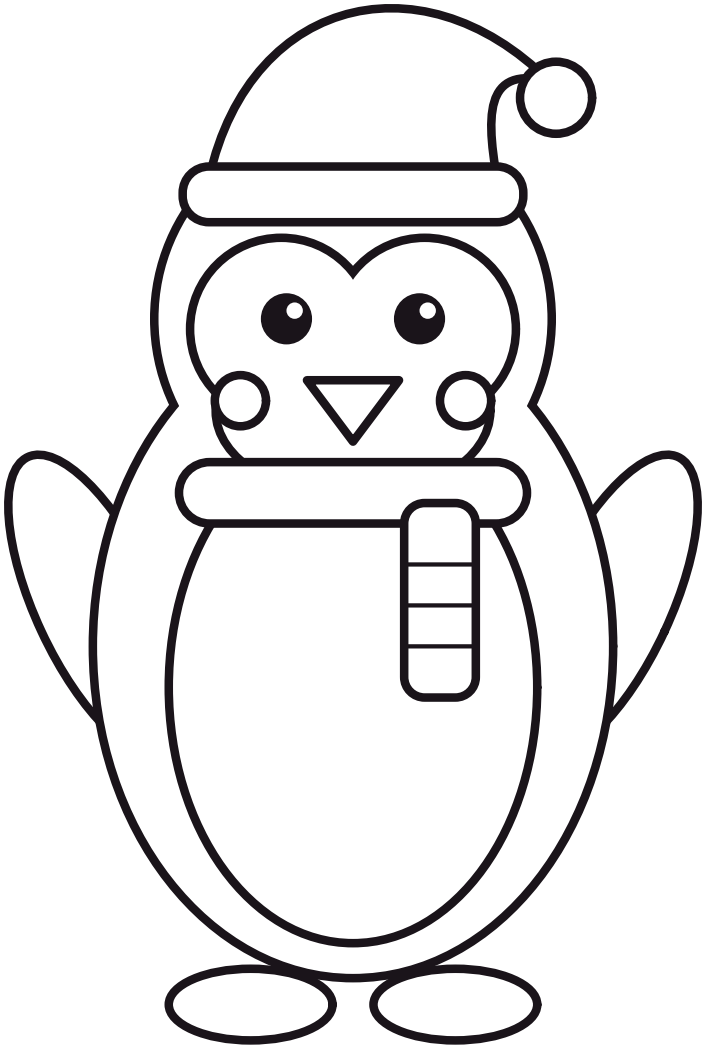
SCHOOL DAY 8

8 School Days to Go!

JOKE OF THE DAY

What do you call a penguin in the desert?

Answer: Lost!



TODAY'S KINDNESS CHALLENGE

Say thank you to the lunch staff.

☐ **I DID IT!**

SCHOOL DAY 9

Snow Day

Find every word hidden in the grid. Words go across, down and diagonally.

E K N C I N T S E W Y G O T
J I U O I B W S G N O V F B
R M C R V T E H O P U B T N
O I C C F K L A D P D I E F
A E B I A E O M I T T E N S
N M R L V C V O J A C K E T
G D F O O S N B P M S N U H
E A H C L C T L D M L L N B
L S N O W F O R T Y E L T O
M Y J V F N V F D H D W W O
U L U R M V J R V S D K B T
P H A R P H M M N R I J S S
D C E J G A S F L R N E R H
S O P U H T D M E A G H C R

- ☐ ANGEL
- ☐ BOOTS
- ☐ COCOA
- ☐ DRIFT
- ☐ FLAKES
- ☐ HAT
- ☐ JACKET
- ☐ MITTENS
- ☐ SCARF
- ☐ SHOVEL
- ☐ SLEDDING
- ☐ SNOWFORT

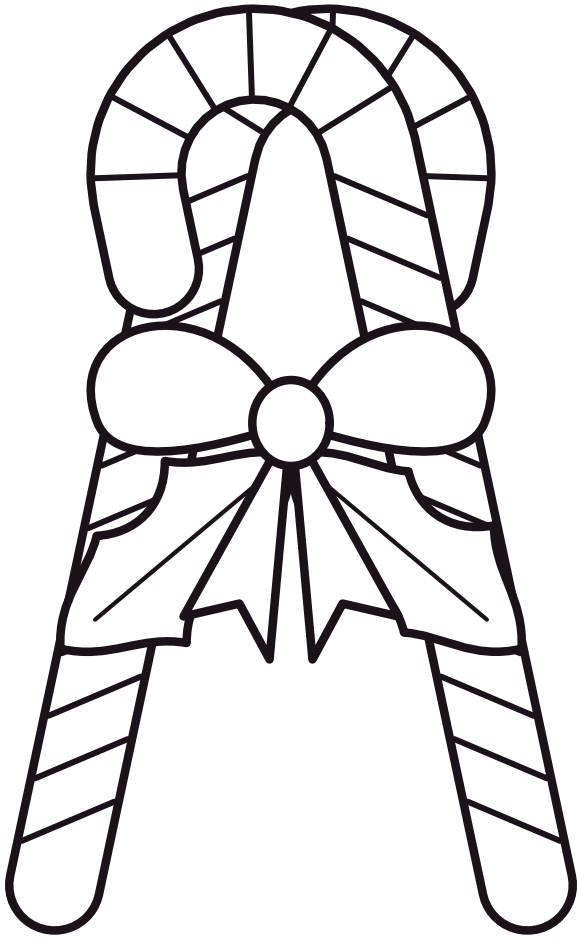
SCHOOL DAY 9

7 School Days to Go!

JOKE OF THE DAY

What did one Christmas tree say to another?

Answer: Lighten up!



TODAY'S KINDNESS CHALLENGE

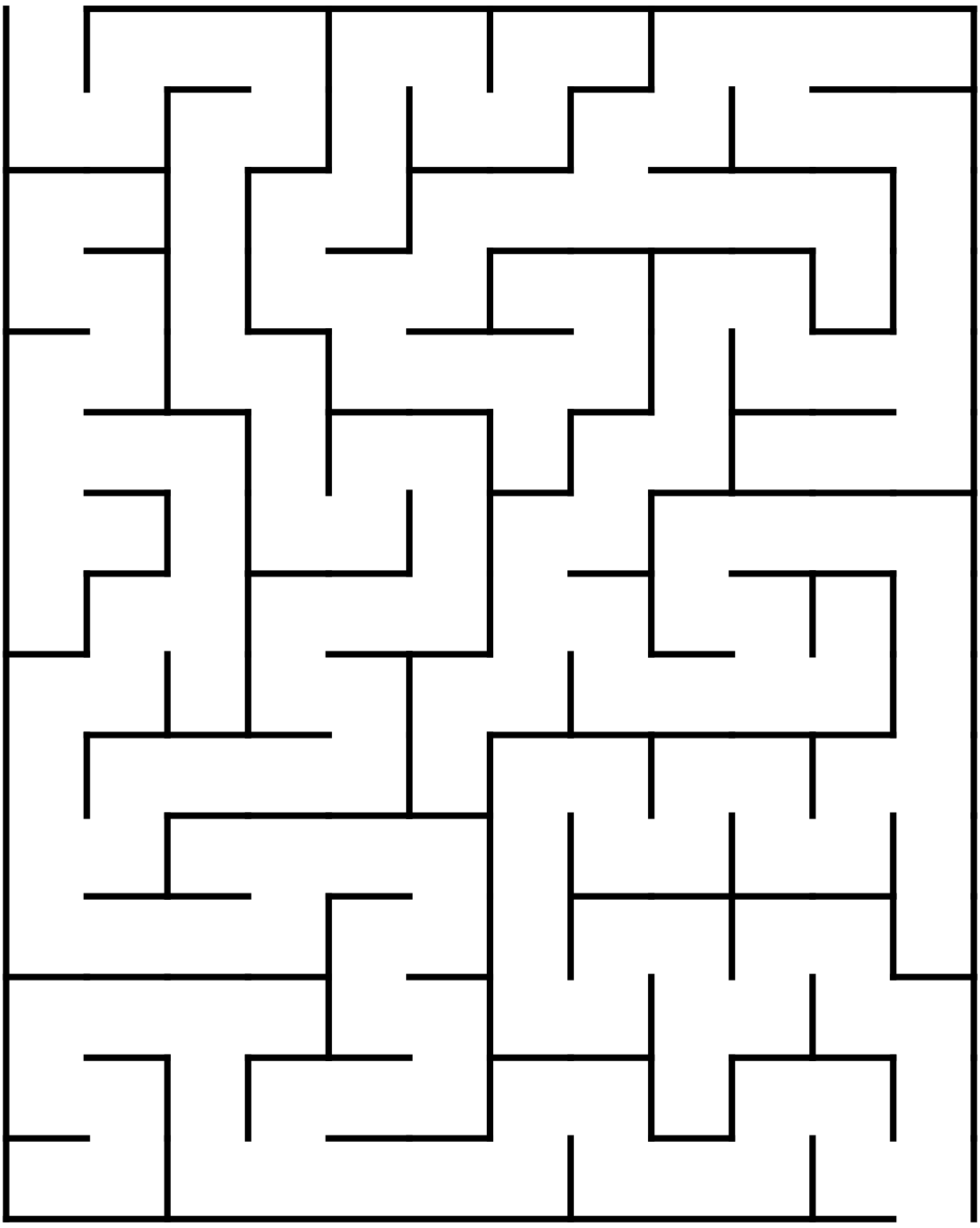
Read a story to a younger student.

☐ **I DID IT!**

Find the way to the gingerbread house

Start at the top. Find the path to the bottom.

START



FINISH

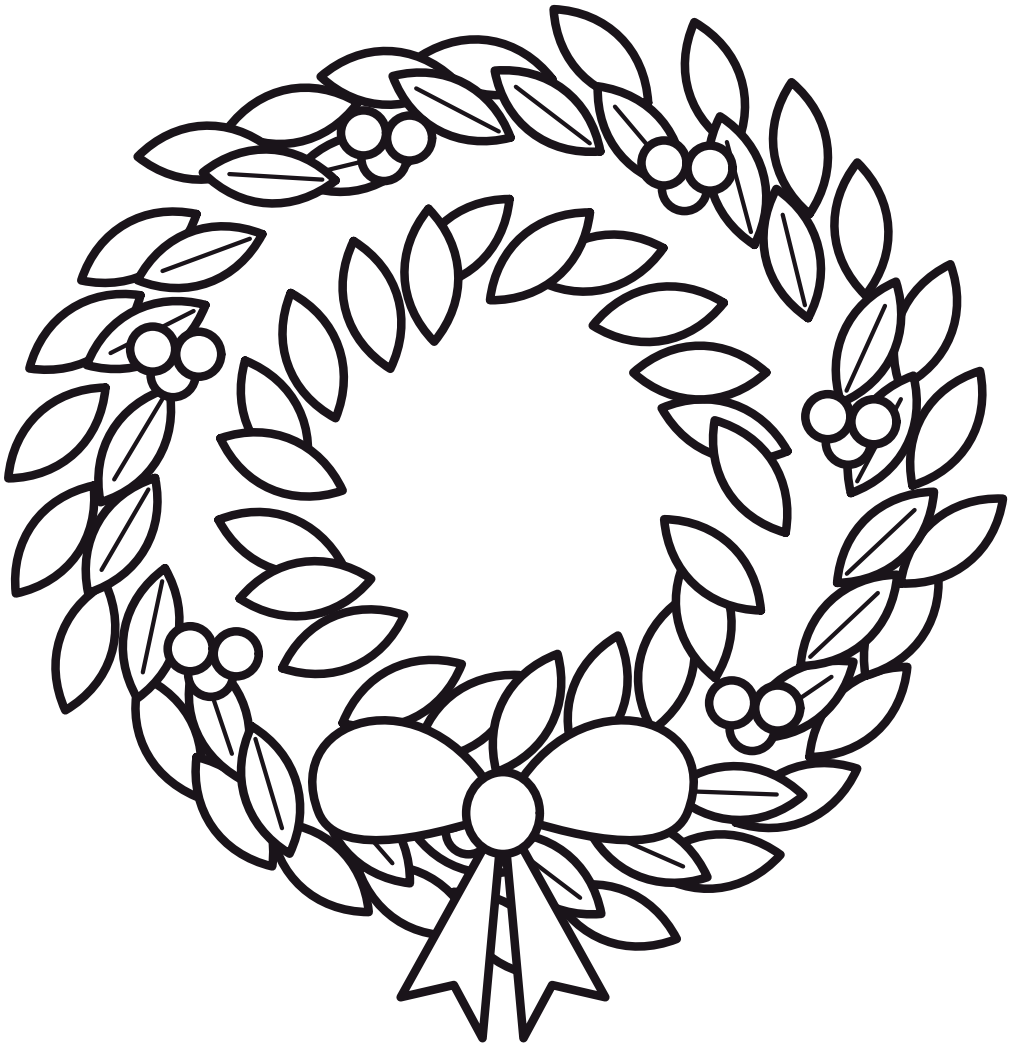
SCHOOL DAY 10

6 School Days to Go!

JOKE OF THE DAY

What do reindeer say before telling a joke?

Answer: This one will sleigh you!



TODAY'S KINDNESS CHALLENGE

Make a paper snowflake for the window.

☐ **I DID IT!**

Secret Messages

The elves sent you a secret message. Use the code key to decode it!

A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13

N	O	P	Q	R	S	T	U	V	W	X	Y	Z
14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26

Secret message 7:

8	21	7		25	15	21	18		6	1	13	9	12	25									

Secret message 8:

20	8	5		14	15	18	20	8		16	15	12	5										

19	1	25	19		8	9																	

Secret message 9:

19	8	1	18	5		25	15	21	18		20	18	5	1	20	19							

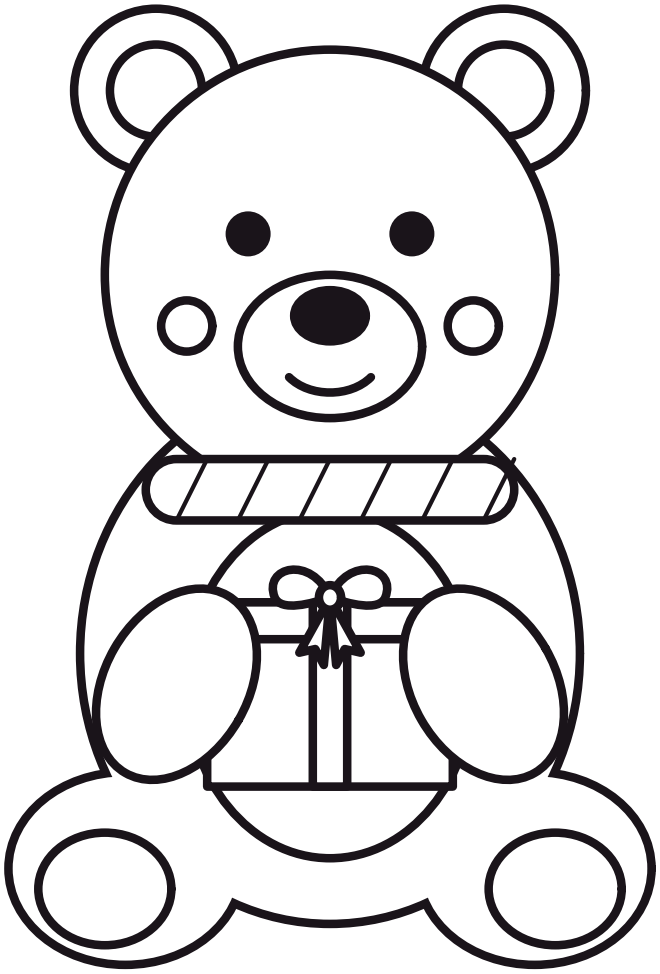
SCHOOL DAY 11

5 School Days to Go!

JOKE OF THE DAY

What did the ornament say to the tree?

Answer: Hang in there!



TODAY'S KINDNESS CHALLENGE

Smile and say hi to five people.

☐ **I DID IT!**

SCHOOL DAY 12

Snow Day Scramble

Unscramble the letters to spell a Christmas word.

1. **L D E S** _____
2. **H E V S L O** _____
3. **B O S O T** _____
4. **K E A C T J** _____
5. **H T A** _____
6. **A K S E F L** _____
7. **R I T F D** _____
8. **A C O C O** _____
9. **O O R N F T S W** _____
10. **E T M I N T** _____

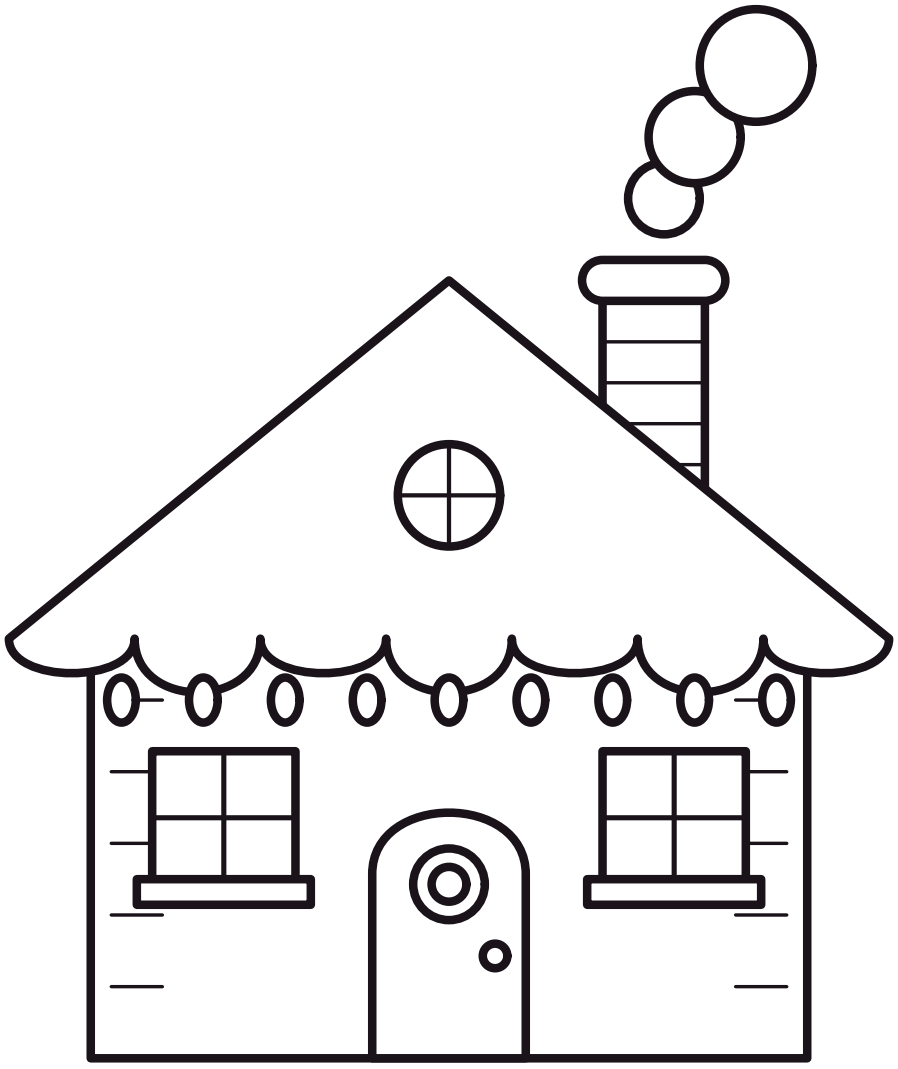
SCHOOL DAY 12

4 School Days to Go!

JOKE OF THE DAY

How does a snowman get around?

Answer: He rides an icicle!



TODAY'S KINDNESS CHALLENGE

Write three things you are thankful for.

☐ **I DID IT!**

SCHOOL DAY 13

At the North Pole

Find every word hidden in the grid. Words go across, down and diagonally.

M	N	B	U	Y	T	K	W	O	I	S	I	H	O
A	Y	O	J	I	U	V	P	W	E	S	G	L	V
I	W	T	Y	E	E	B	E	V	R	W	L	I	A
L	W	K	H	M	F	L	L	E	W	S	O	S	R
R	S	O	E	O	B	E	T	M	Y	R	O	T	E
O	E	O	R	A	L	T	H	O	D	E	I	W	O
O	F	Y	T	K	E	V	T	T	S	I	K	M	W
M	M	S	M	L	S	K	E	B	P	N	T	R	L
A	P	S	F	A	H	H	F	S	H	D	A	L	W
B	G	N	I	T	D	A	O	J	L	E	S	D	I
M	E	A	R	H	R	W	F	P	D	E	T	C	I
G	L	O	P	B	S	P	O	L	A	R	I	K	E
T	N	N	A	C	M	H	Y	A	B	Y	K	G	L
J	I	S	D	W	V	F	M	E	I	T	K	P	H

- ☐ ELVES
- ☐ IGLOO
- ☐ LETTERS
- ☐ LIST
- ☐ MAILROOM
- ☐ NORTH
- ☐ POLAR
- ☐ REINDEER
- ☐ SLEIGH
- ☐ STABLE
- ☐ TOYS
- ☐ WORKSHOP

SCHOOL DAY 13

3 School Days to Go!

JOKE OF THE DAY

Why did Santa's helper go to the doctor?

Answer: He had low elf esteem!



TODAY'S KINDNESS CHALLENGE

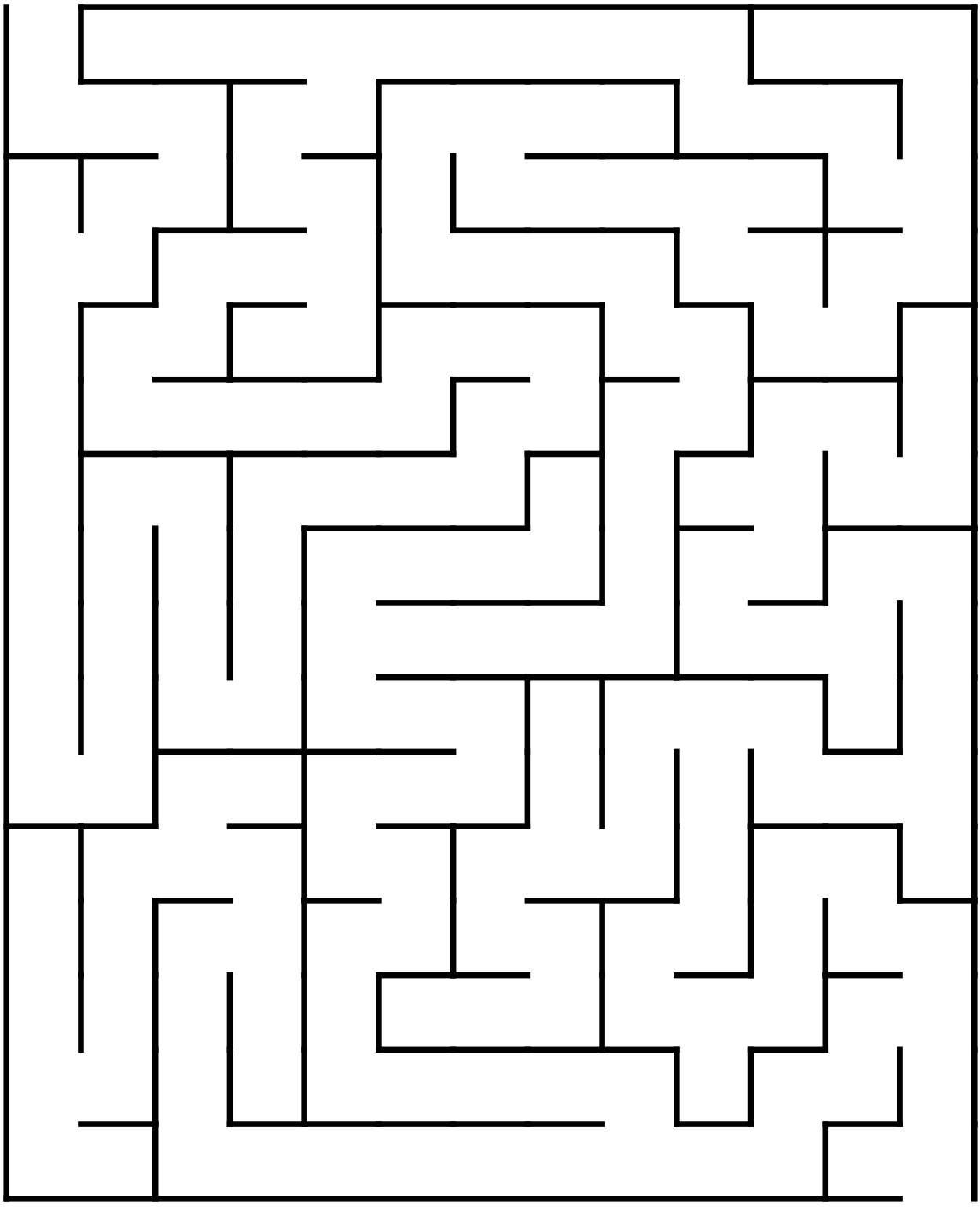
Tell a joke to make someone laugh.

☐ **I DID IT!**

Lead the reindeer to the barn

Start at the top. Find the path to the bottom.

START



FINISH

SCHOOL DAY 14

2 School Days to Go!

JOKE OF THE DAY

What does a snowman eat for lunch?

Answer: An icebergr!



TODAY'S KINDNESS CHALLENGE

Thank the custodian for keeping school clean. ☐ **I DID IT!**

Secret Messages

The elves sent you a secret message. Use the code key to decode it!

A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13

N	O	P	Q	R	S	T	U	V	W	X	Y	Z
14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26

Secret message 10:

19	9	14	7		1		3	1	18	15	12		20	15	4	1	25							

Secret message 11:

13	1	11	5		1		23	9	19	8						

Secret message 12:

19	20	1	25		23	1	18	13		1	14	4		3	15	26	25							

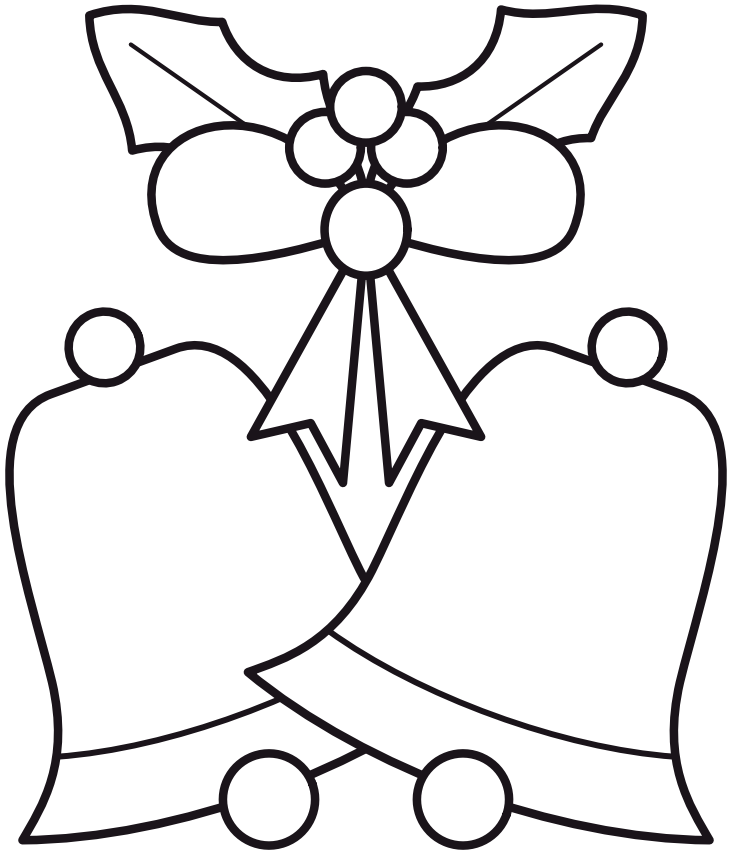
SCHOOL DAY 15

Last Day Before Break!

JOKE OF THE DAY

What do elves do after school?

Answer: Their gnome-work!



TODAY'S KINDNESS CHALLENGE

Draw a picture for someone at home.

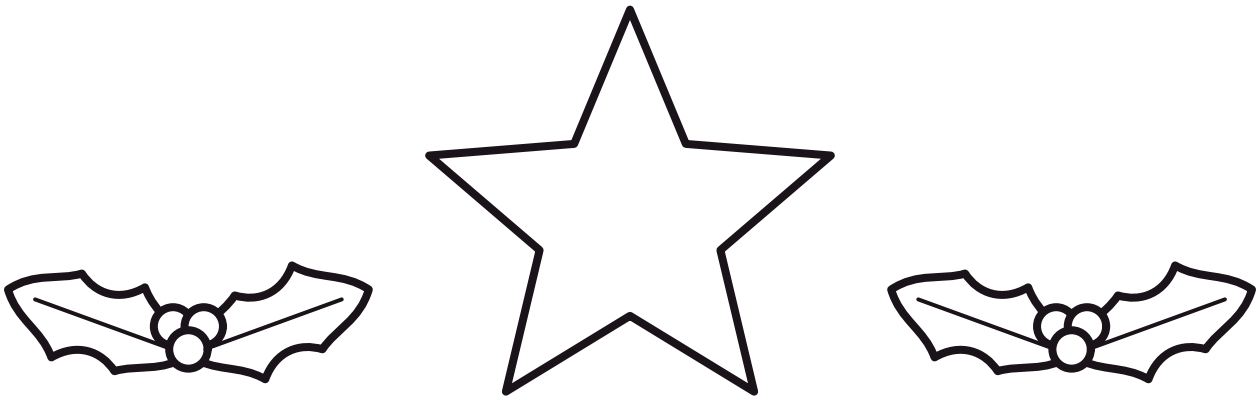
☐ **I DID IT!**

MERRY CHRISTMAS!

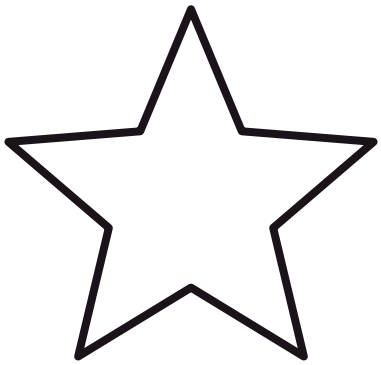
THIS CERTIFICATE IS AWARDED TO

_____

for finishing all 15 school days of the Christmas Countdown, with 15 puzzles and 15 acts of kindness. Well done!

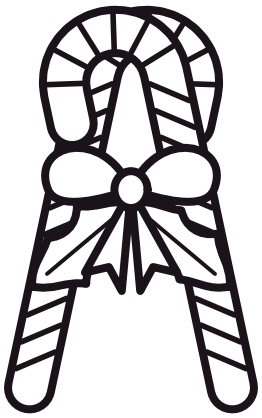


Date: _____



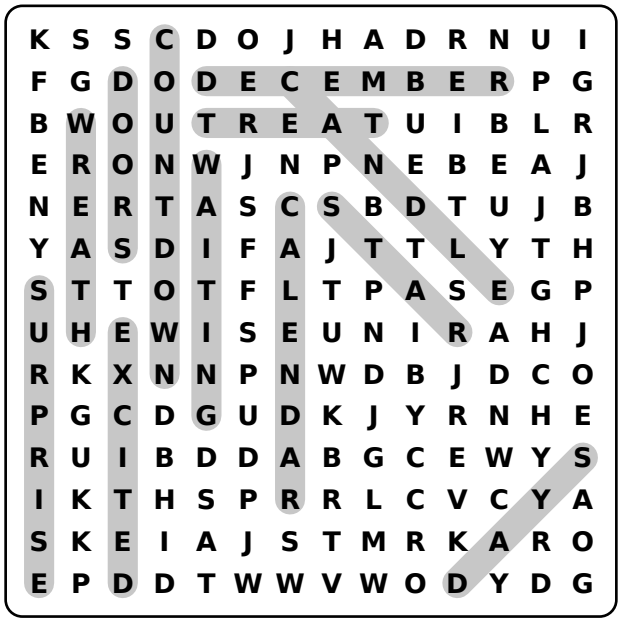
ANSWERS

Each answer shows the page its puzzle is on.

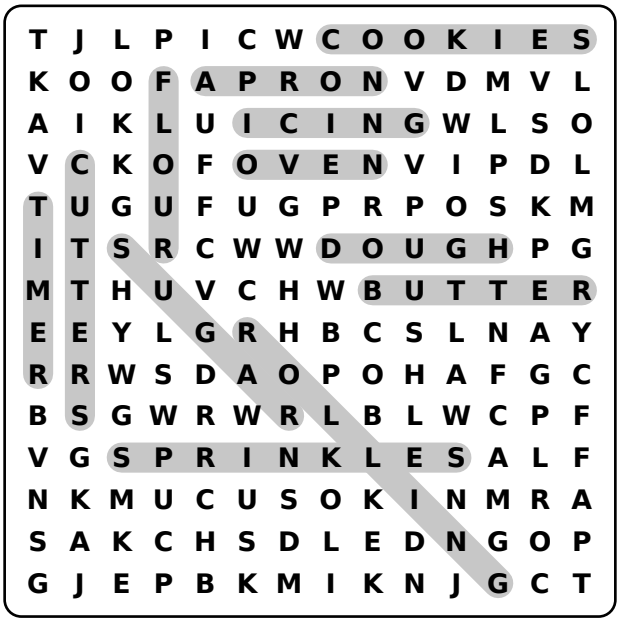


Word Search Answers

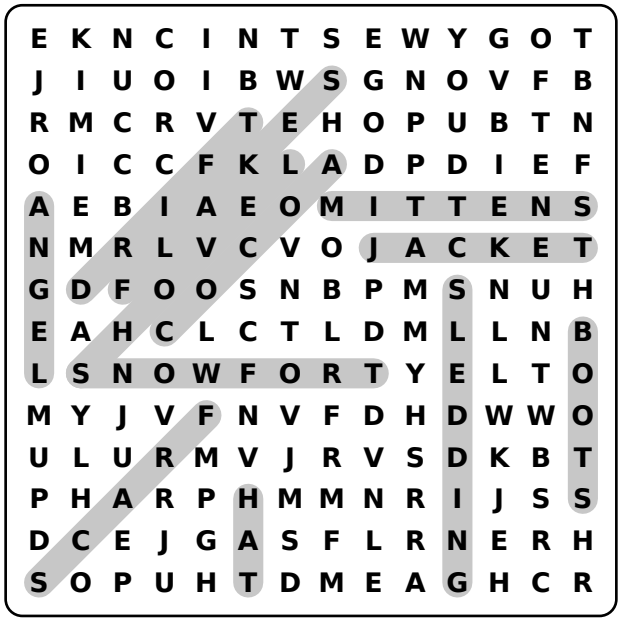
Page 6: Counting Down



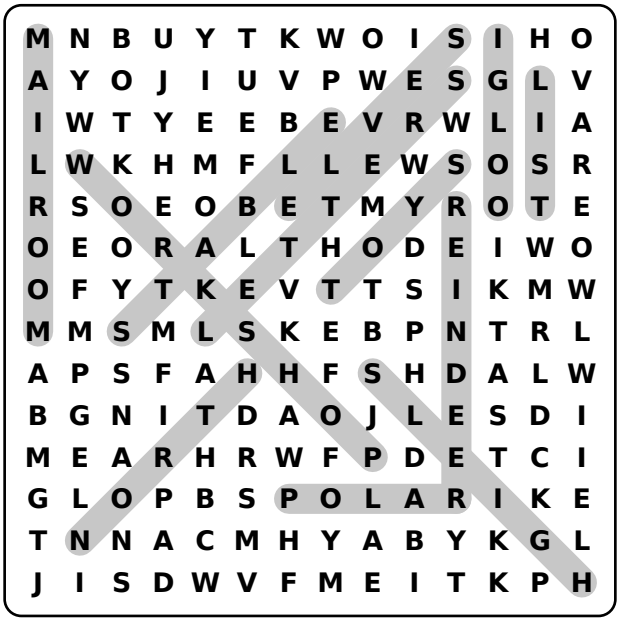
Page 14: Holiday Baking



Page 22: Snow Day

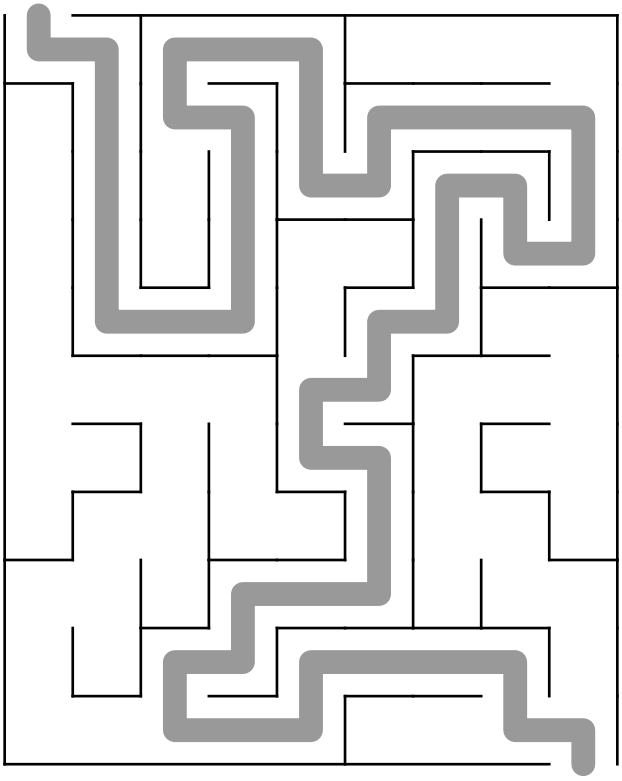


Page 30: At the North Pole

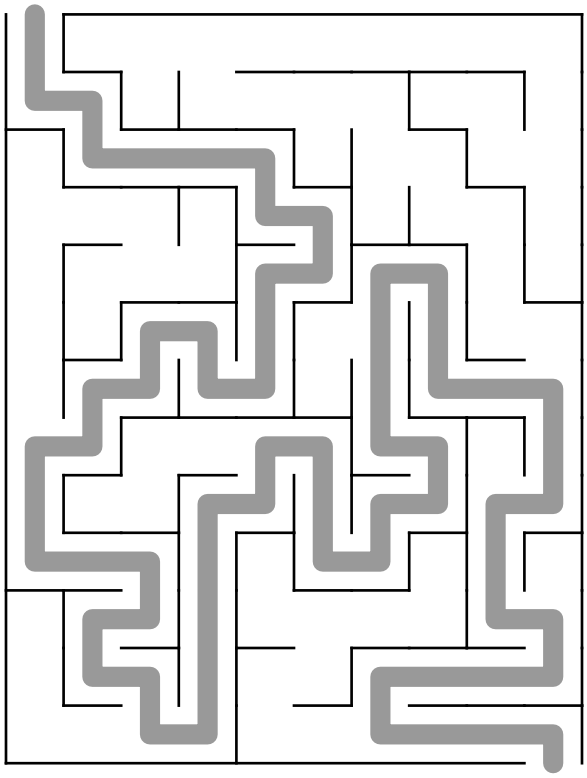


Maze Answers

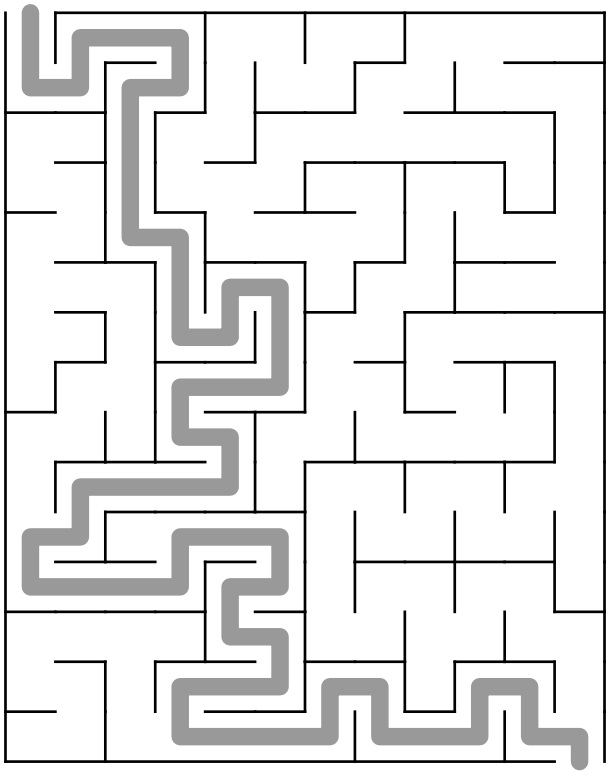
Page 8



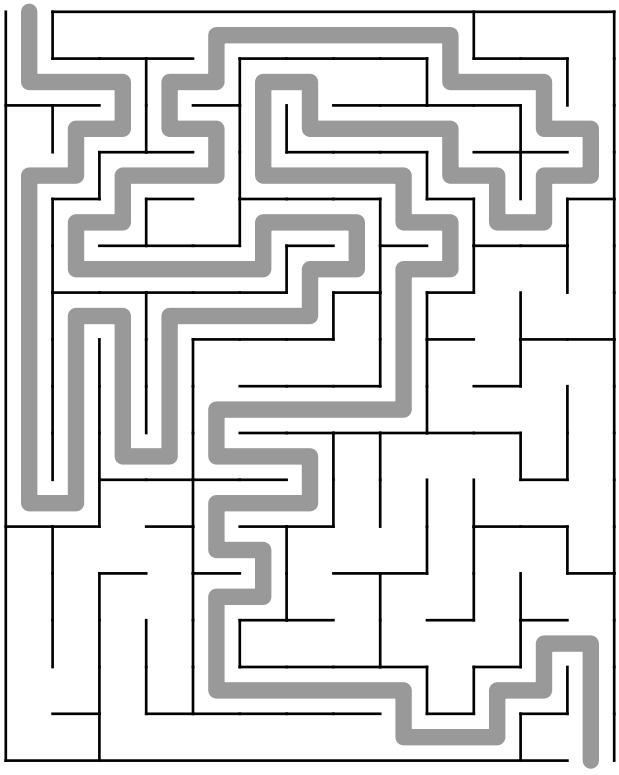
Page 16



Page 24



Page 32



Scramble and Code Answers

Page 12

1. FLOUR
2. SUGAR
3. BUTTER
4. DOUGH
5. OVEN
6. APRON
7. ICING
8. TIMER
9. BAKER
10. MIXER

Page 28

1. SLED
2. SHOVEL
3. BOOTS
4. JACKET
5. HAT
6. FLAKES
7. DRIFT
8. COCOA
9. SNOWFORT
10. MITTEN

Page 10

SANTA IS COMING SOON
YOU ARE ON THE NICE LIST
HAVE A COOKIE TODAY

Page 18

THE REINDEER ARE READY
LOOK OUT FOR SNOW
KINDNESS IS MAGIC

Page 26

HUG YOUR FAMILY
THE NORTH POLE SAYS HI
SHARE YOUR TREATS

Page 34

SING A CAROL TODAY
MAKE A WISH
STAY WARM AND COZY

Sudoku Answers

Page 20, Puzzle A

5	4	**2**	1	3	**6**
6	3	1	**4**	5	**2**
4	**1**	**6**	5	2	**3**
3	2	**5**	**6**	1	**4**
1	**6**	3	**2**	**4**	5
2	**5**	4	**3**	6	1

Page 20, Puzzle B

1	**2**	**6**	**5**	**4**	3
4	**5**	**3**	6	**1**	**2**
6	4	2	1	3	**5**
3	1	5	**4**	2	6
2	**6**	1	**3**	5	**4**
5	**3**	4	2	**6**	**1**

DOODLE PAGE

Holiday Doodles

Use this page for anything you like!